

Firearms Trace Data: Illinois - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

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ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in Illinois in Calendar Year 2023

22,973

Firearm Types with an Illinois Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	18,544
Revolvers	1,465
Rifles	1,397
Shotguns	858
Machinegun Conversion Devices	392
Machineguns	129
Other*	188

*Other includes Derringers, Unknown Types, Receivers/Frames, Any Other Weapons and a Combination.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with an Illinois Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	11,716
.40 Cal	2,751
.45 Cal	1,425
.22 Cal	1,303
.380 Cal	1,112

12GA	653
.38 Cal	639
5.56mm	407
.357 Cal	333
7.62mm	317

NOTE: There were 1,737 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 580 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with an Illinois Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Firearm Under Investigation	11,076
Weapon Offense	4,453
Possession of Weapon	3,081
Found Firearm	1,489
Dangerous Drugs	417
Family Offense	399
Homicide	329
Aggravated Assault	288
Suicide	217
Robbery	163

NOTE: There were 1,061 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with an Illinois Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Illinois	9,147
Indiana	2,796
Missouri	952
Wisconsin	663
Mississippi	419
Kentucky	405
Tennessee	390
Georgia	367
Texas	315
Iowa	303
Ohio	248
Alabama	198
Arizona	187
Florida	173
Michigan	159

NOTE: An additional 35 states and Puerto Rico accounted for 1,086 other traces. The source state was identified in 17,808 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with an Illinois Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	889
3 Months to Under 7 Months	1,152
7 Months to Under 1 Year	1,191
1 Year to Under 2 Years	2,912
2 Years to Under 3 Years	2,904
3 Years and Over	8,599

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Illinois Average Time-to-Crime: **6.28 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with an Illinois Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	802
18 to 21	1,847
22 to 24	1,325
25 to 30	2,160
31 to 40	2,658
41 to 50	1,205
Over 50	1,292

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 Illinois Average Age of Possessor: **33 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with an Illinois Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Chicago	11,460
Springfield	566
Rockford	564
Peoria	456
East Saint Louis	424
Joliet	333
Decatur	269
Waukegan	182
Aurora	177
Belleville	169
Kankakee	169

NOTE: There were 603 additional municipalities that accounted for 8,023 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for 181 traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of Illinois. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to Illinois.
- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 – 12/31/2023.

- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with an Illinois Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with an Illinois Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with an Illinois Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with an Illinois Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with an Illinois Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with an Illinois Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024